

Did the IMF confirm the developers?

A developers' claim, tested against the IMF report and Eurostat

THE CLAIM

“The IMF’s assessment of the Maltese housing market confirms what the Malta Developers Association...”

Malta Developers Association, release of 8 February 2026

“...for several years.” On the IMF’s 2025 Article IV report on Malta.

We read the IMF report and the MDA’s release in full.

VERDICT

LARGELY SUPPORTED

*Sound on valuation;
risks left out.*

SUPPORTED

LARGELY
SUPPORTED

NOT
SUBSTANTIATED

MISLEADING

CONTRADICTED

MAIN RESULTS

–10.7%

Incomes grew faster than prices

Eurostat price-to-income ratio, 2015–2024; now below its long-term average.

“Aligned”

IMF: ratios “stable”

Prices “aligned with fundamentals”; weakening “currently low”.

72%

Banks tied to property

Share of private loans; the IMF calls it “a vulnerability”.

2000

Not the first EU economy

Luxembourg was on the IMF’s two-year cycle in 2000–02. Malta is the only EU member on it now.

110

Above the EU, not “far”

GDP per head in purchasing power, EU = 100 (2025); 102 at market prices.

FAIR TO SAY

The statement is right about what the IMF said on valuation and stability. It leaves out the IMF’s warnings on banks and fast price growth, and the IMF did not assess affordability. The two-year IMF cycle the release cites is real.

WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT

☐ The release as first published.

☐ The MDA-commissioned study.

☐ The basis for “first EU economy”.

☐ Affordability for renters.